

has given a boost to the antacid and digestive enzymes industries, pushing up overall industrial production in May 2017 by 2.4 per cent. (Source: <http://dgit.in/eatoutoftent>)

The government has facilitated the overall growth of startups greatly over the last couple of years. According to Niti Aayog CEO Amitabh Kant, speaking at the Entrepreneur India Congress 2017, the Government has scrapped more than 1200 laws to help startups and MSMEs grow in India. In fact, there are more than 50 schemes from the government that every startup should know about and you can find a comprehensive list at <http://dgit.in/igstartup>.

On the other hand, it's not entirely happy days for the world of startups. Big names like Stayzilla and Taskbob have fallen due to insufficient funds. Snapdeal has almost lost its entire market share and is currently considering an acquisition deal from Flipkart worth close to a billion. Flipkart itself is looking for support from Snapdeal backer Softbank (and possibly Alibaba, Softbank's co-investor in PayTM) to stave off Amazon's growing dominance over the Indian e-commerce market. Overall, Indian startups will have to switch away from the 'me-too' model of innovation due to the sheer number of startups out there.

MANUFACTURING

It's not just startups that have seen a lot of action in the last few years. With labour prices in China rising to the lower-European price range, quite a lot of manufacturers from around the world, including India itself, are looking at India as the next big manufacturing hub for several sectors. While right now, the manufacturing sector only accounts for about 16-17 per cent of the country's GDP, there is a lot of untapped potential to be explored. And there are a lot of things afoot with the goal of doing exactly that.

One of the major segments in manufacturing that is propelling its current growth is defence. Military equipment, vehicles and more are increasingly being made in India.

For instance, Lockheed Martin, in partnership with Tata Advanced System Limited (TASL), will be moving the manufacturing of F-16 fighter jets to India, on the condition that a contract to supply fighter jets to the Indian Air Force is granted to them. Apart from this, Lockheed Martin also relies heavily on TASL for manufacturing crucial components for its C-130J Super Hercules, S92

was imported. But we still have a long way to go in terms of setting up infrastructure that is capable of manufacturing components for the electronics industry.

However, if you were to zoom out of these specific sectors and look at the big picture, the results are not too great. Overall, the manufacturing sector had to bear the brunt of a couple of government policy



One of the most widely used military aircrafts in the world, the F-16, will now be manufactured exclusively in India

helicopters and more. Additionally, as a part of an Indo-Russian joint venture, 140 Kamov helicopters will be manufactured in India. On the other hand, we are not just importing designs – the INS Saryu, a Made-in-India 105-metre long warship is expected to be commissioned into the Sri Lankan Navy on August 2. It will be the largest warship in the Sri Lankan naval fleet.

Beyond all things military, the other manufacturing sector that looks to be working out great for India is smartphones. Since the Make in India initiative was announced, around 40 mobile manufacturing plants have been set up around the country that collectively make more than 20 million phones every month. While in most cases these are components imported from abroad that are being assembled here, it is a step up from the situation a couple of years ago when the entire stock

changes – specifically, demonetisation and GST. While the impact of demonetisation was something the industry was recovering from, the GST implementation is something that most companies are still dealing with. The demonetisation policy directly affected jobs, taking away roughly 1.5 million manufacturing jobs according to a survey by Centre for Monitoring Indian Economy (CMIE). While the GST policy is unlikely to stop people from buying stuff, it has put a lot of intermediate steps in the manufacturing process into temporary jeopardy. Sorting this out should be one of the top priorities for the companies, as well as the government.

One other area the manufacturing industry needs to focus on right now is incorporating the latest innovations being adopted around the globe. The Internet of things is especially taking manufacturing pro-